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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Mark Zuckerberg** called the head of the FTC in late March, saying that Meta would pay \$450 million to settle a long-running anti-trust case that was about to go to trial, and then upped the offer to \$1 billion in a vain attempt to avoid a trial. **A1**
- ◆ **Zuckerberg defended** Meta against allegations that it was an unlawful monopolist, testifying that it had legitimate reasons for acquiring Instagram in 2012. **A2**
- ◆ **Chinese officials** told domestic airlines not to place new orders for Boeing jets and are requiring carriers to seek approval before taking delivery of already ordered aircraft. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** slipped, with the S&P 500 and Dow shedding 0.2% and 0.4%, respectively, and the Nasdaq losing less than 0.1%. **B11**
- ◆ **United Airlines** swung to a profit in the first quarter and beat Wall Street's earnings guidance despite falling air-travel demand. **B1**
- ◆ **Bank of America** and Citigroup said consumer spending ticked higher in the first quarter, when concerns about the economy began to surface. **B1**
- ◆ **A major Harley-Davidson** shareholder is preparing to launch a fight to shake up the motorcycle maker's board and quickly replace its CEO. **B1**
- ◆ **Some large lenders** pulled back from some electronic information-sharing with the OCC after it disclosed a cyber-attack earlier this month. **B2**
- ◆ **J&J raised its sales outlook** for the year even as it prepares to face new headwinds, saying overall healthcare demand remains solid. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The Trump administration** plans to use ongoing tariff negotiations to pressure U.S. trading partners to limit their dealings with China, a strategy promoted by Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent. **A6**
- ◆ **China's economic growth** held steady in the first quarter, helped by government stimulus and a rush of exports to the U.S. ahead of new tariffs, though the economy is set to slow amid the trade war. **A8**
- ◆ **Trump threatened** to revoke Harvard's tax-exempt status, escalating a feud over antisemitism concerns and academic freedom. **A3**
- ◆ **A Palestinian student** at Columbia University was detained by immigration agents at a citizenship interview. **A3**
- ◆ **Biden, in his first** major speech since leaving office, accused Trump of seeking to gut Social Security. **A4**
- ◆ **The Agriculture Department** is fast-tracking state requests to yank soda and candy from food-stamp programs. **A3**
- ◆ **Gary Shapley**, who accused the Biden Justice Department of slow-walking a probe of Hunger Biden's tax filings, has been named the IRS's acting leader. **A2**
- ◆ **About 1 in 31 children** aged 8 years old in 2022 had autism, an increase from previous years, according to a CDC report. **A2**
- ◆ **Senior Trump aides** advised him to be more skeptical of Russia's stated desire for peace with Ukraine. **A8**
- ◆ **Died: Elaine Wynn**, 82, co-founder of Wynn Resorts. **B2** ... **Wink Martindale**, 91, genial TV game-show host. **A2**

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As Trade Tensions Rise, Xi Makes Goodwill Tour



NEIGHBORS: China's President Xi Jinping—traveling on a Boeing 747 as Beijing barred new orders from the U.S. jet maker—arrives Tuesday in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia. China and the U.S. are putting pressure on allies to choose sides in the trade war. **A6**

Inside Zuckerberg's Failed Effort to End Antitrust Case

Mark Zuckerberg called the head of the Federal Trade Commission in late March with an offer: Meta would pay \$450 million to settle a long-

By Dana Mattioli, Rebecca Ballhaus and Josh Dawsey

running antitrust case that was about to go to trial.

The offer was far from the \$30 billion that the FTC had demanded. It was also a fraction of the value of Instagram and

WhatsApp, the two apps Meta had bought and were at the heart of the government's case.

On the call, Zuckerberg sounded confident that President Trump would back him up with the FTC, people familiar with the matter said. The billionaire Facebook co-founder had been developing closer ties to Trump—his company donated \$1 million to Trump's inauguration and settled a \$25 million lawsuit—and had been pressing the president in recent weeks to intervene in the

monopoly lawsuit.

FTC Chairman Andrew Ferguson found the offer not credible, and wasn't ready to settle for anything less than \$18 billion and a consent decree. As the trial approached, Meta upped its offer to close to \$1 billion, the people said, and Zuckerberg led a frenzied lobbying effort to avoid the FTC trial.

It wasn't enough. On Monday, the trial kicked off. The FTC called Zuckerberg—who privately expressed reluctance about taking the stand—to

testify for four hours.

Zuckerberg was back on the witness stand Tuesday, where he faced questioning from an FTC lawyer over whether Facebook had paid \$1 billion to buy Instagram to “neutralize” a competitor.

Asked if he would have preferred that Facebook's own camera app would have grown faster, Zuckerberg responded,

◆ **Zuckerberg defends deal to acquire Instagram..... A2**

Younger Generation Flocks to Mom & Dad Inc.

By Rachel Wolfe

The closer John Welsh came to earning his graphic-design degree, the worse the job market seemed. By the time he was ready to graduate in 2022, he was seriously considering ditching his chosen field and taking up his dad's offer to work for the family metal-fabrication business.

“It feels so impersonal just sending off your résumé to whatever job you see,” said Welsh, who is 25 years old and has worked for three years as a purchaser at his dad's company in Plymouth, Minn. “Versus going back to a place where I grew up working and was already familiar with everyone.”

Welsh now plans to eventually take over Seelye Craftsmen alongside his older brother, who also surprised their dad, Tom, by going to work for the family firm.

A young generation is taking a bigger interest in joining the family business, spurred by a cooling labor market that is making it more difficult to land entry-level jobs, economists and business analysts said.

At the same time, their parents and grandparents—baby boomers and Gen Xers who own the most of the U.S.'s businesses—are feeling more urgency about making succession plans as they look toward retirement.

The share of small businesses that employ a young adult child of an owner has doubled since 2018 and is up 13% year-over-year as of January to about 1,200, according

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Long-Covid patients continue to struggle with cognitive difficulties. **A12**

SPORTS

The Warriors are a big threat—they just have to make the playoffs first. **A14**

Have Fun on Spring Break, Kids. I'll Be Right Next Door.

Parents join teens to share the experience, monitor their drinking, manage the sunscreen

By Tara Weiss

Stone Seyburn just got back from Riviera Maya, Mexico, where he and his friends spent a week partying on the beach in what was a prototypical spring break in every way except one.

Every morning the 18-year-old checked in with his parents, who were staying in a first-floor suite at the same hotel, to see what was on their schedule. On a few nights he met them for dinner.

“I want to be here as a parent knowing that my child is going to be drinking,” said Alisa Seyburn, of Commerce Township, Mich., who joined her youngest on the trip along

with her husband, two older sons and one of their girlfriends. “I want to share the experience with my son. I can go to an adults-only resort any time. He's the reason we came.”

High-school seniors may be leaving home for college in a few months, but some parents aren't ready to let them party on their own in countries where the drinking age is 18. They also don't want to be a buzzkill by saying no to senior spring break. The compromise: Mom and dad are packing their sunblock and bathing suits and coming along.

“There are plenty of parents

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Little-Known Group Tears Through Universities

A new task force formed to combat antisemitism is using funding threats to force broader changes on campus

Columbia University's president had already been hounded out of office, but her ordeal wasn't over.

Four days after she stepped down under government pressure during fraught federal funding negotiations, Katrina Armstrong

By Liz Essley Whyte, Douglas Belkin and Sara Randazzo

spent three hours being deposed by a government attorney in Washington, D.C. The lawyer grilled Armstrong over whether she had done enough to protect Jewish students against antisemitism.

As she dodged specifics under questioning, the lawyer said her answer “makes ab-

solutely no sense” and that he was “baffled” by her leadership style.

“I'm just trying to understand how you have such a terrible memory of specific incidents of antisemitism when you're clearly an intelligent doctor,” he said.

The attorney in the room during the April 1 deposition, a senior Health and Human Services official named Sean Keveney, is part of a little-known government task force that has shaken elite American universities to their core in recent weeks. It has targeted billions of dollars in federal funding at premiere institutions such as Columbia and Harvard, with cascading effects on campuses nationwide. Now it is pressing to put

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Boeing Is Hit From All Sides In Tariff Turmoil

China restricts new orders and deliveries from the struggling U.S. plane maker

By Sharon Terlep

In the global trade war, Boeing is a big loser.

Chinese officials told domestic airlines not to place new orders for Boeing jets and are requiring carriers to seek approval before taking delivery of already ordered aircraft, according to people familiar with the matter.

The tariff turmoil keeps getting worse for the U.S.'s largest exporter: Boeing's vast and fragile supply chain is grappling with the end of its decadeslong duty-free status. Boeing faces retaliatory tariffs from other countries. And airlines are bracing for a drop in demand for air travel.

The developments add pressure to the struggling jet maker, which burned through \$14 billion last year and had aimed to be cash-flow positive by the end of this year. Long-term, the new tariff landscape could give a leg up to Boeing's European archrival, Airbus.

President Trump has said his tariff blitz is intended to boost U.S. manufacturing. But the trade war is hurting—not helping—one of the few major

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◆ **China's growth held steady ahead of tariffs..... A8**

◆ **Tariff break for auto parts creates new challenge.... B1**

◆ **Heard on the Street: U.S. has trade-war leverage... B12**

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